learned the NSA was capable of following every person in a city by monitoring their cell phones, computers, or other electronic devices. The NSA's surveillance capabilities astounded Snowden, and it seemed to him the organization worked on its own with no oversight from the rest of the government.

Snowden's faith in the US Intelligence Community was slowly eroding. Even so, the community continued to value Snowden's technical expertise. In 2011, he took a job as lead technologist—a computer-problem fixer—at Dell's Maryland office. He worked on the CIA's account. But rather than easing his dissatisfaction with US intelligence, the position soured Snowden even more.

Hawaii: Point of No Return

In March 2012, Dell moved Snowden to its Hawaii office, a dank, underground former torpedo storage facility. The tech position again gave Snowden access to top-secret documents detailing the NSA's surveillance activities. For example, he discovered the NSA was passing retrieved e-mails and phone calls made by millions of Arab and Palestinian Americans to Israeli intelligence, without first removing identifying

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